Driving Subscription Growth Through Viewer Behaviour Insights

User, Content & Engagement Analysis with Strategic Recommendations

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April 2026

Approach to Identifying Growth Opportunities

01 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

02 USER & USAGE TRENDS

03 INSIGHTS THROUGH SEGMENTATION

04 KEY DRIVERS OF CONSUMPTION

05 INSIGHTS & RECOMMENDATION

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY | Low engagement and underutilised time periods present the largest opportunity for subscription growth

Viewership is growing, with usage concentrated in afternoons and weekends

~69% of sessions are low engagement, indicating high casual usage

Young adults drive volume, but not necessarily deeper engagement

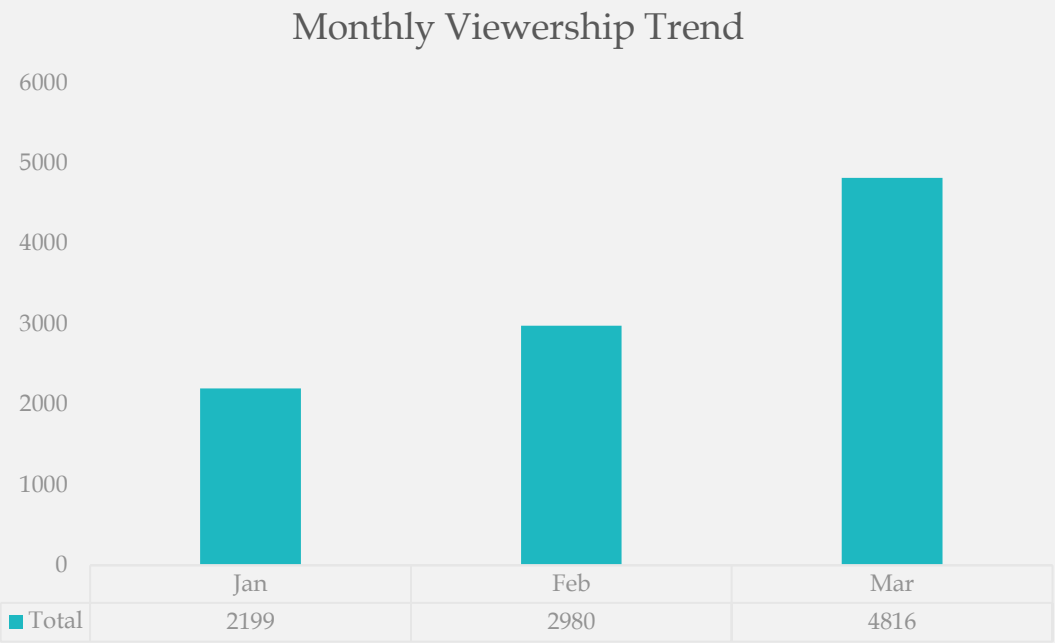
A small number of channels drive most views, but not necessarily the highest engagement

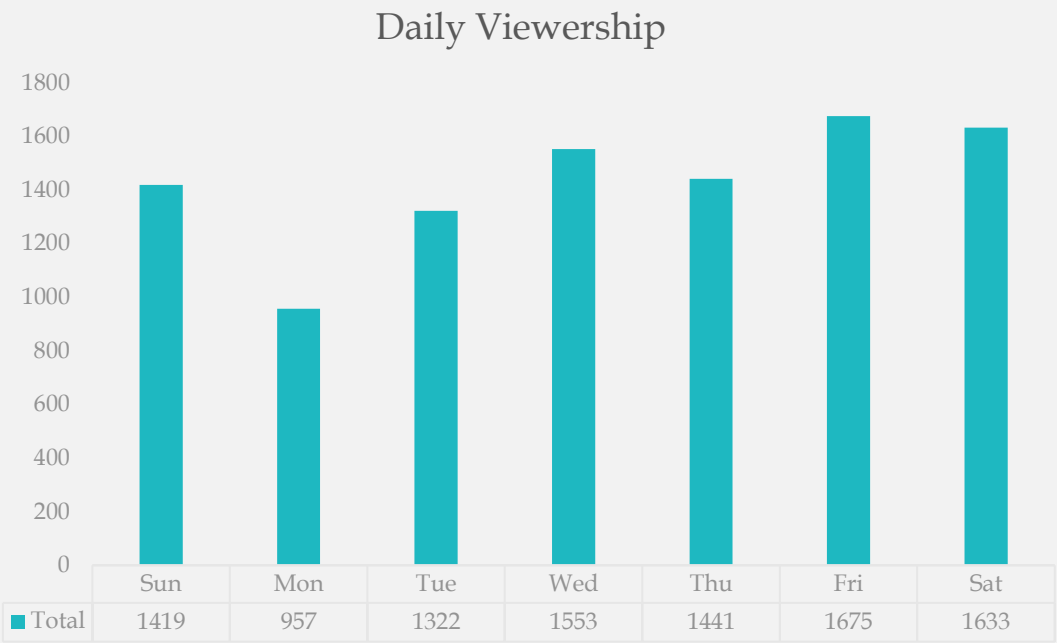
Weekday mornings represent untapped consumption potential

Key Opportunity

Subscription rowth will come from **increasing engagement per user**, not just acquiring more users

Viewership is rapidly growing, with peak usage concentrated over weekends



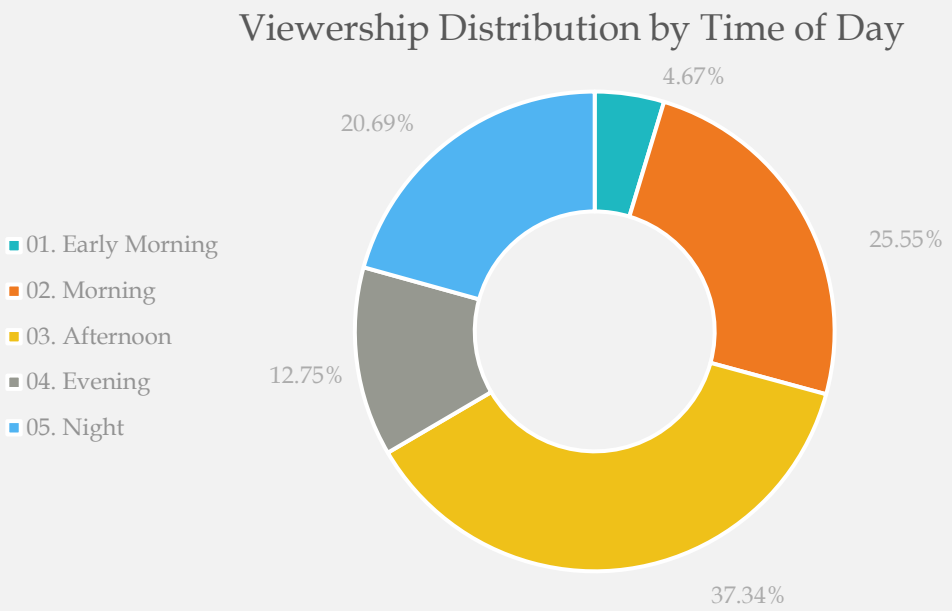


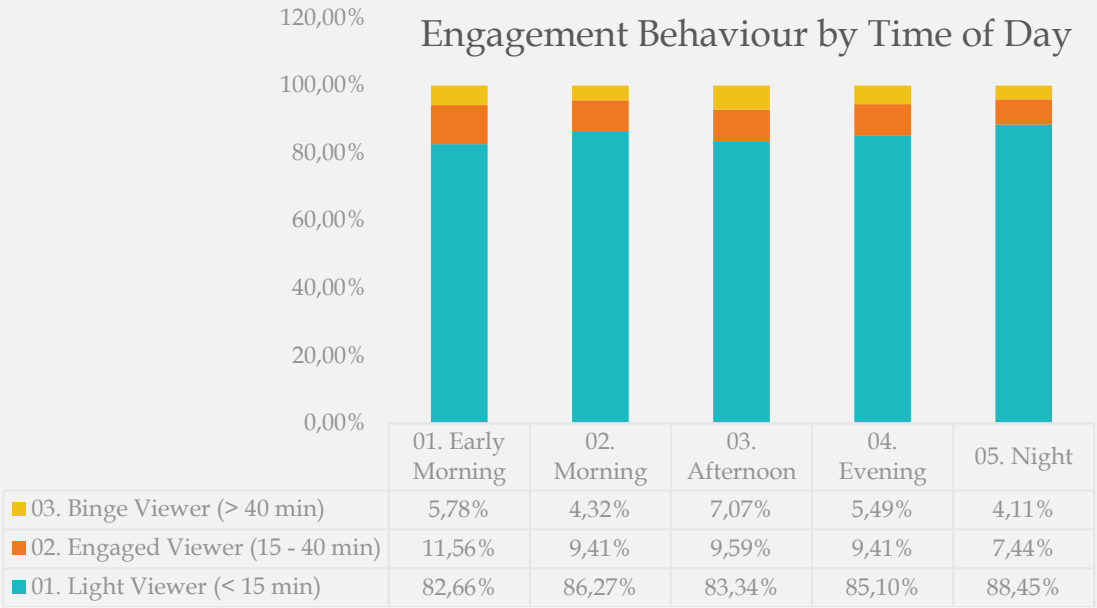
- Viewership shows a steady increase over the observed period, with viewership more than doubling in March relative to January
- Peak usage occurring on Friday, and Saturday.
- Usage aligns with **leisure availability patterns**

BrightTV is already embedded in **leisure behaviour,** therefore, opportunity lies in deepening usage during these periods not just expanding reach

Note: *April records reflect only one day*

Afternoons drive volume, but evenings drive deeper engagement



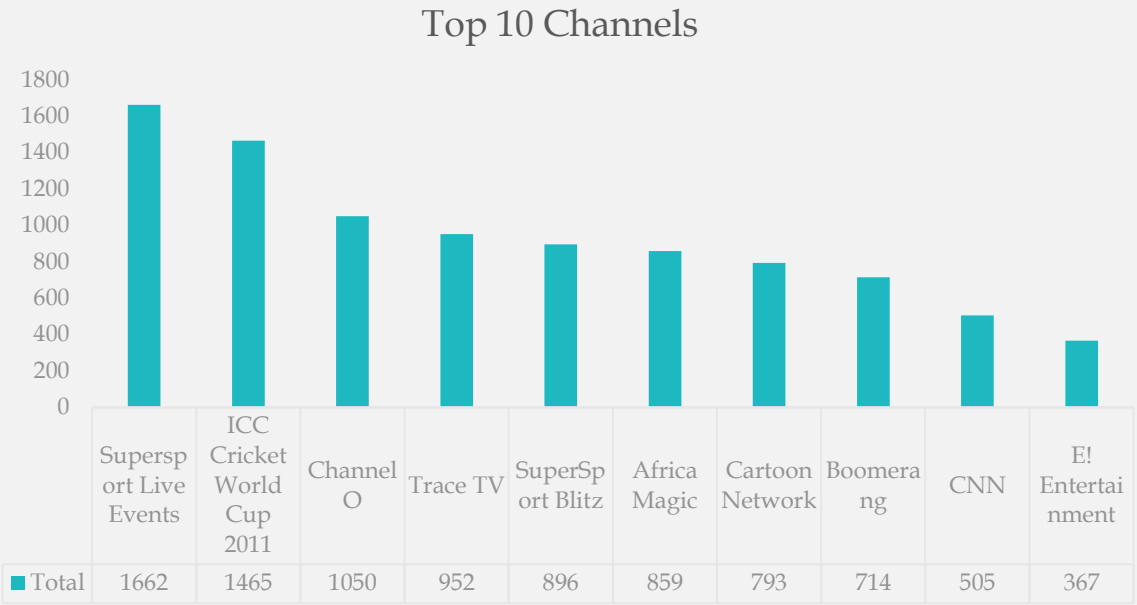


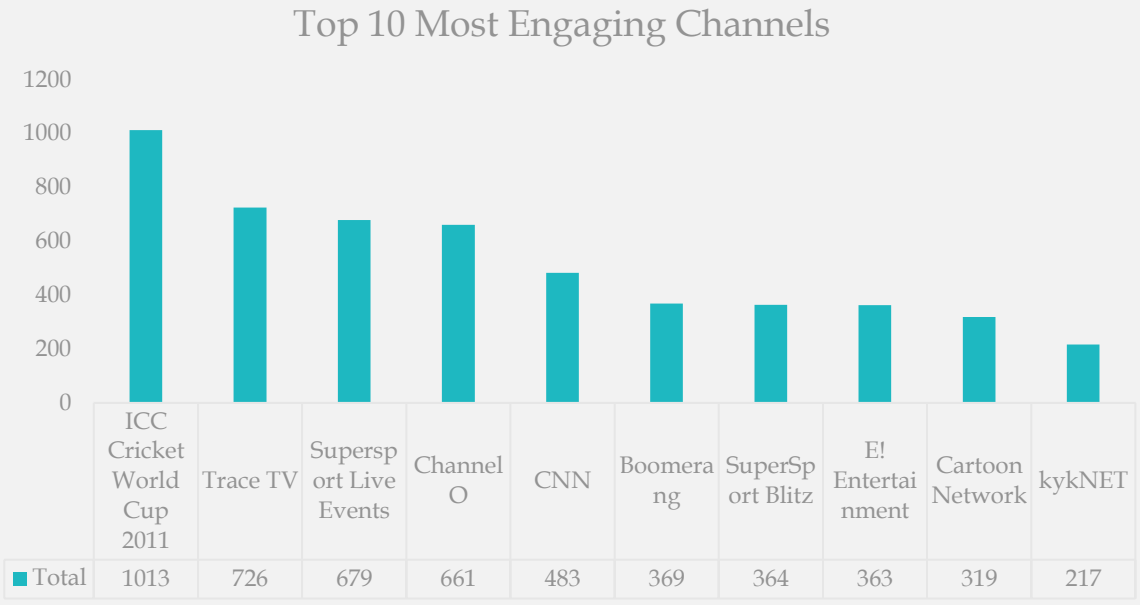
	01. Early Morning	02. Morning	03. Afternoon	04. Evening	05. Night
03. Binge Viewer (> 40 min)	5,78%	4,32%	7,07%	5,49%	4,11%
02. Engaged Viewer (15 - 40 min)	11,56%	9,41%	9,59%	9,41%	7,44%
01. Light Viewer (< 15 min)	82,66%	86,27%	83,34%	85,10%	88,45%

- Afternoon accounts for the highest share of total viewership (37%) , followed by evening and night (combined) (~33%), which suggests that usage is driven by availability after working hours
- Evening and night (combined) sessions show **higher proportions of engaged and binge viewers** (~17% and ~10%, respectively)
- Low engagement dominates, highlighting a major conversion opportunity

Engagement is driven by time , afternoons and evenings are high-value viewing periods

A small set of channels drive volume, but not engagement



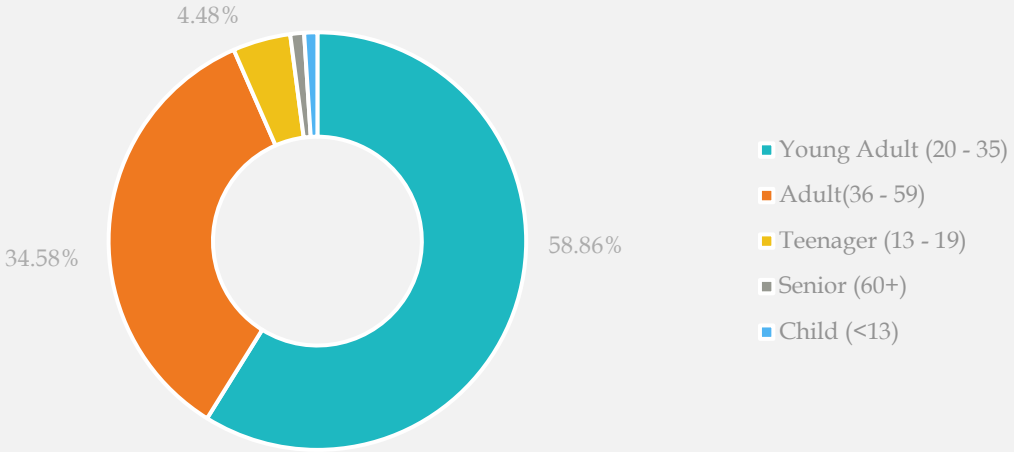


- Viewership is concentrated across a limited number of high-performing channels
- High-view channels do not necessarily have high watch time
- Some lower-volume channels drive **strong engagement**

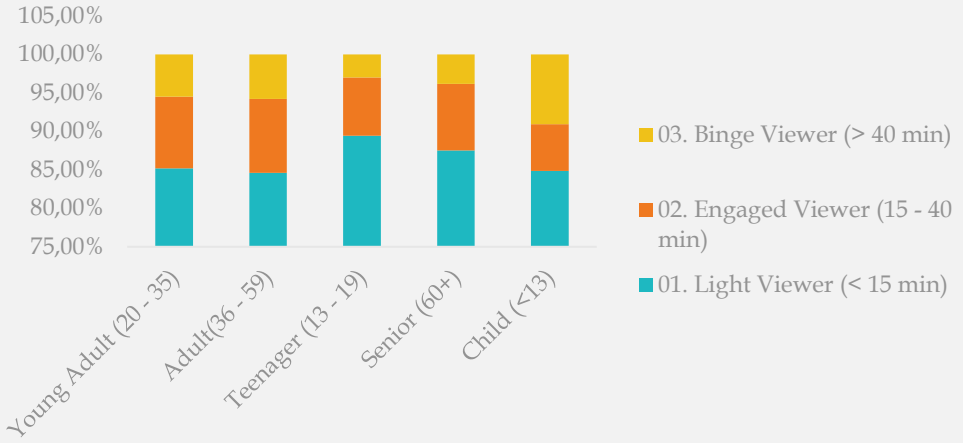
Promoting the *right content* (not just popular content) can significantly improve engagement which would increase retention

Young adults drive volume, while children show highest engagement depth

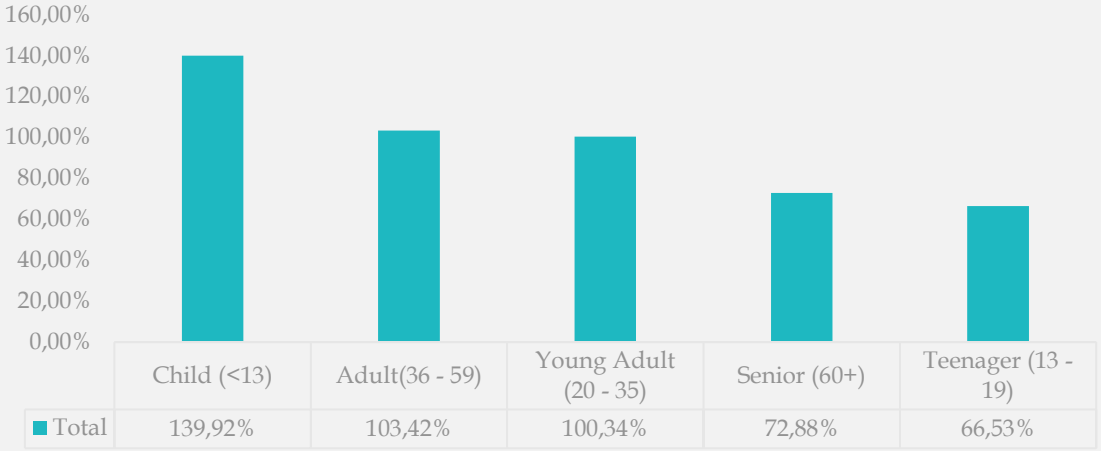
User Age Distribution



Engagement Behaviour by Age



Average Watch Time by Age



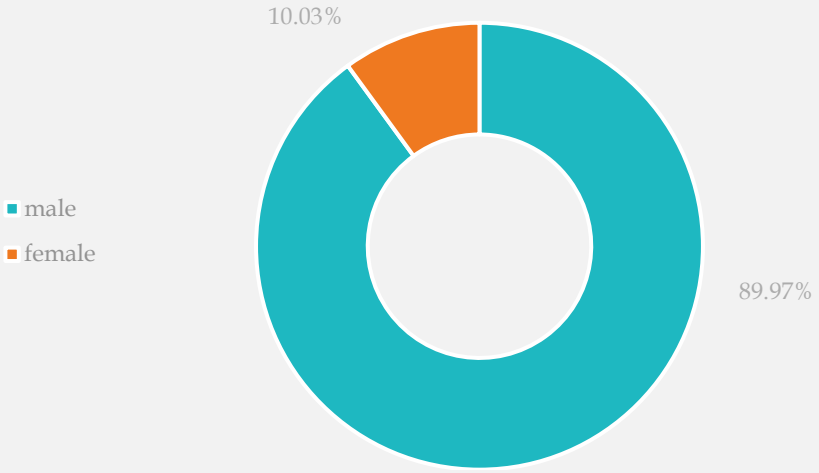
- ~59% of users are young adults, making them the core user base, followed by adult (~36%). The child and senior segments account for >3% of users
- Children, although small in number, have the **highest average watch time,** followed by young adult & adult segments
- Young adults and adults segment show the highest engaged behaviour (~9% & ~10% respectively), and children show a higher tendency toward binge behaviour (~9%)

Growth strategy should focus on **young adults for scale** and leverage **high-engagement segments (children)** for retention tactics

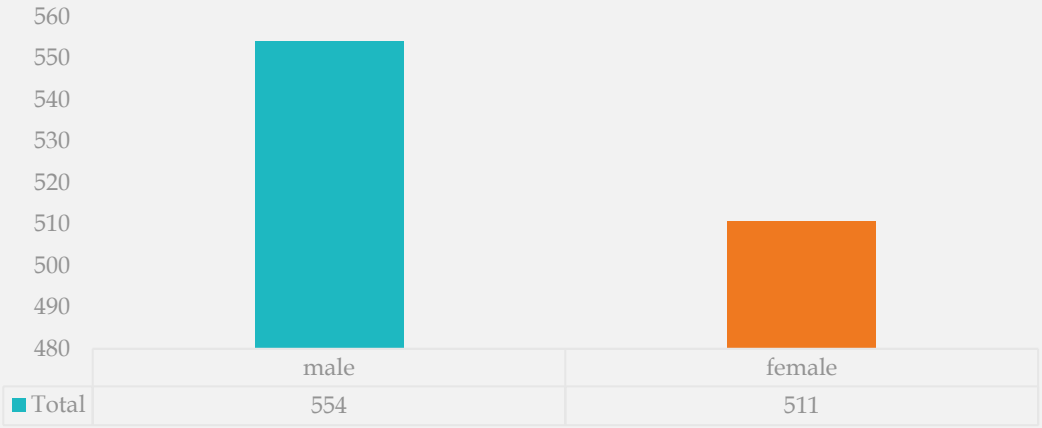
Note: we had 260 (<3%) unknown records

Gender does not significantly influence viewing behaviour or engagement

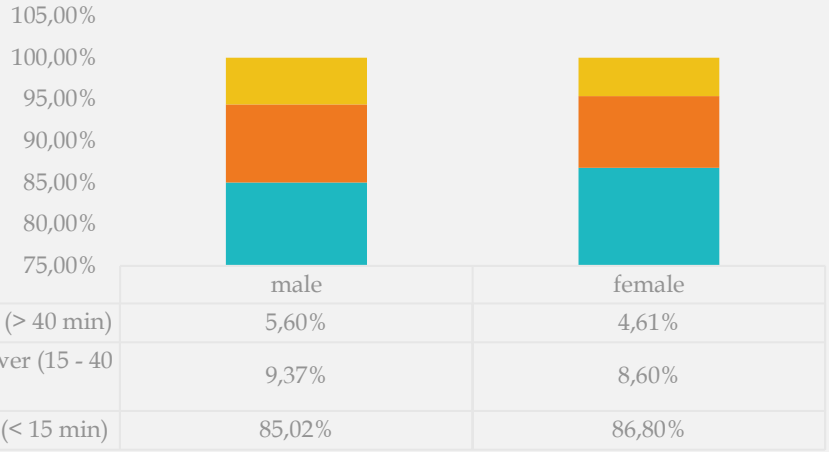
Gender Distribution



Watch Time Distribution by Gender



Engagement Behaviour by Gender

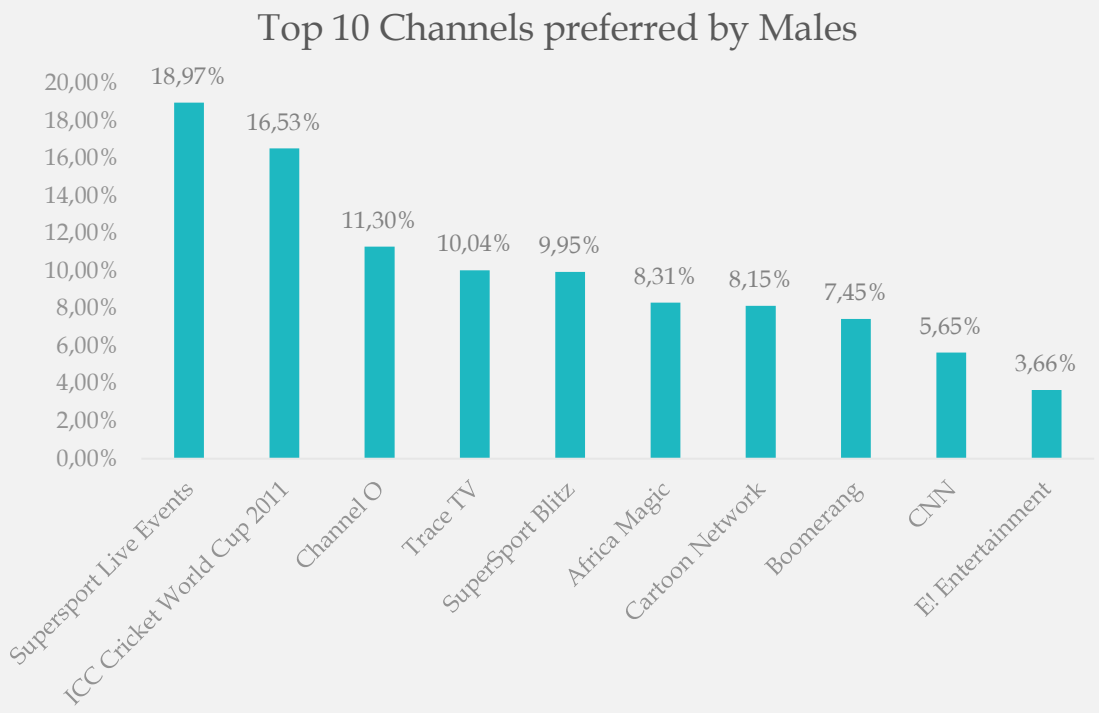


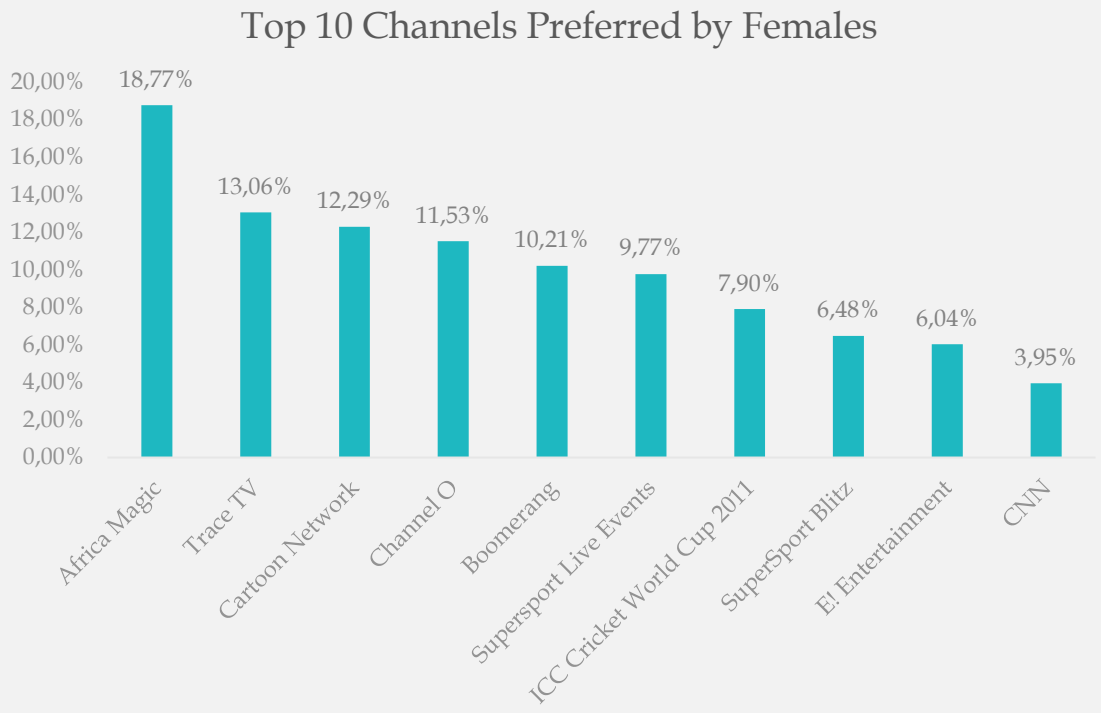
- Male users dominate volume (~90%)
- However, male and female users display similar viewing patterns across time and engagement (with marginal differences)
- There's no significant difference in average watch time between genders
- Gender is not a primary driver of consumption behaviour

Gender is **not a strong lever for growth targeting**

Note: we had 262 (<3%) unknown records

Content preferences differ by gender despite similar viewing behaviour



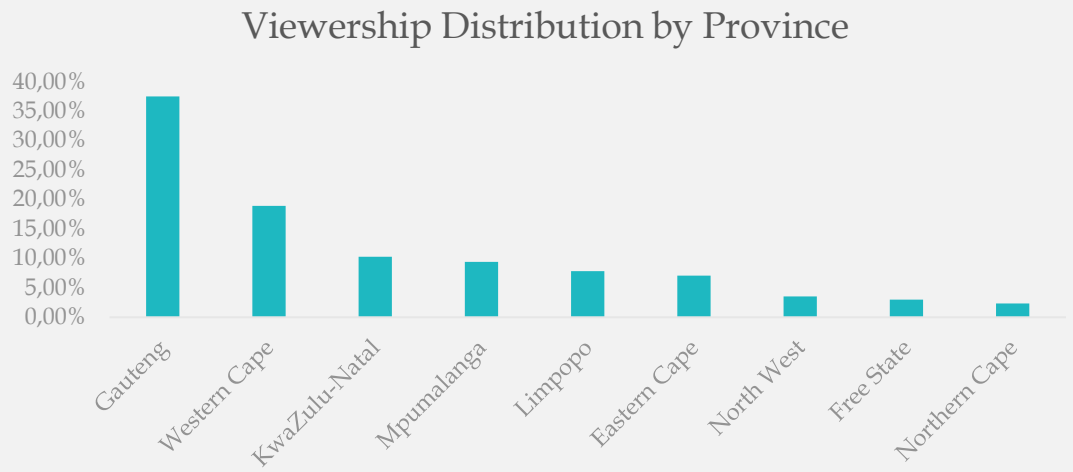


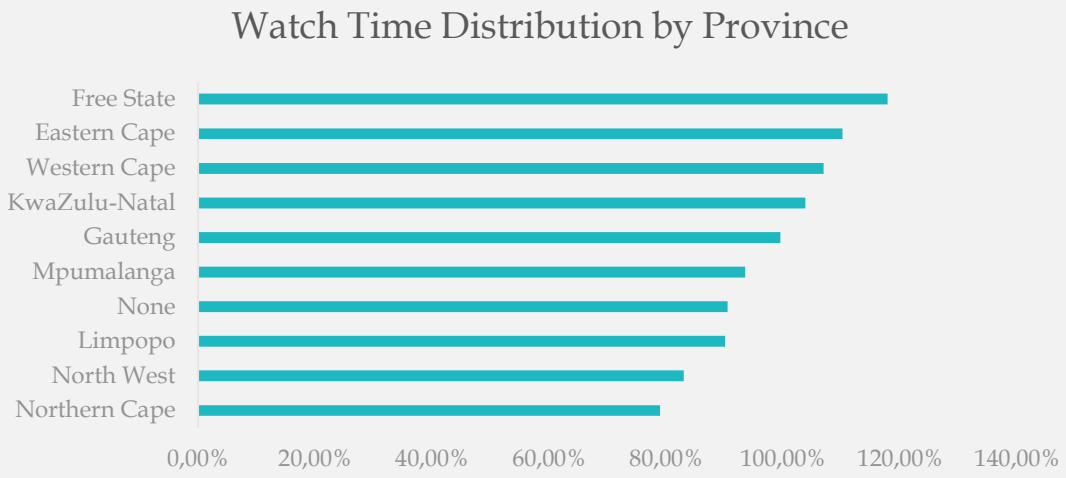
- **Content preferences differ by gender**: male viewership is concentrated in sports and music channels (~43%), while female viewership is driven by entertainment and music channels (~41%).
- Behaviour (time, engagement) is similar, but **content taste varies**

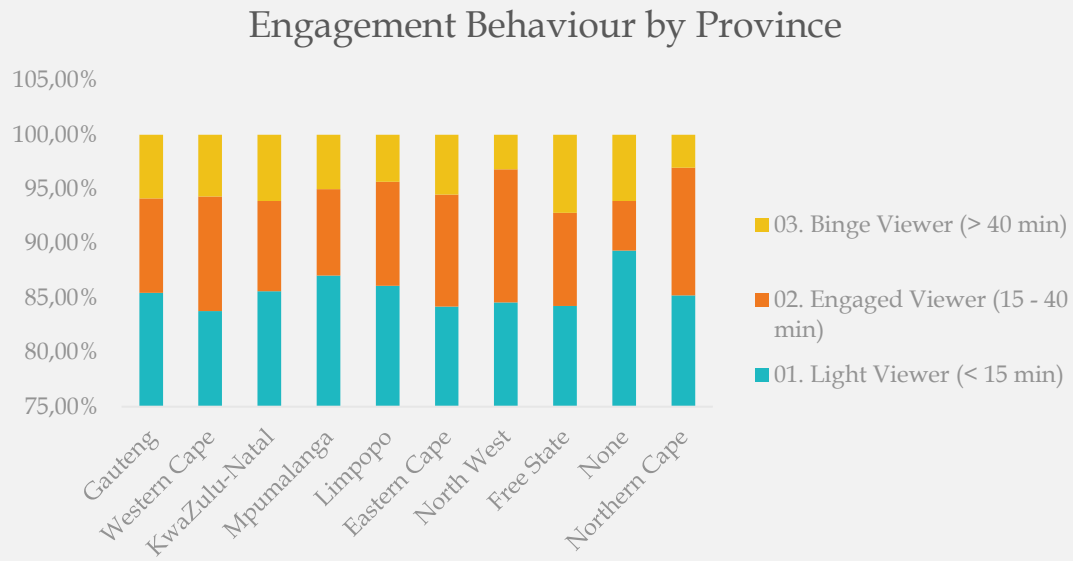
Personalisation should focus on **content preferences, not behaviour differences**

Note: we had 262 (<3%) unknown records

High-volume provinces do not always drive the highest engagement





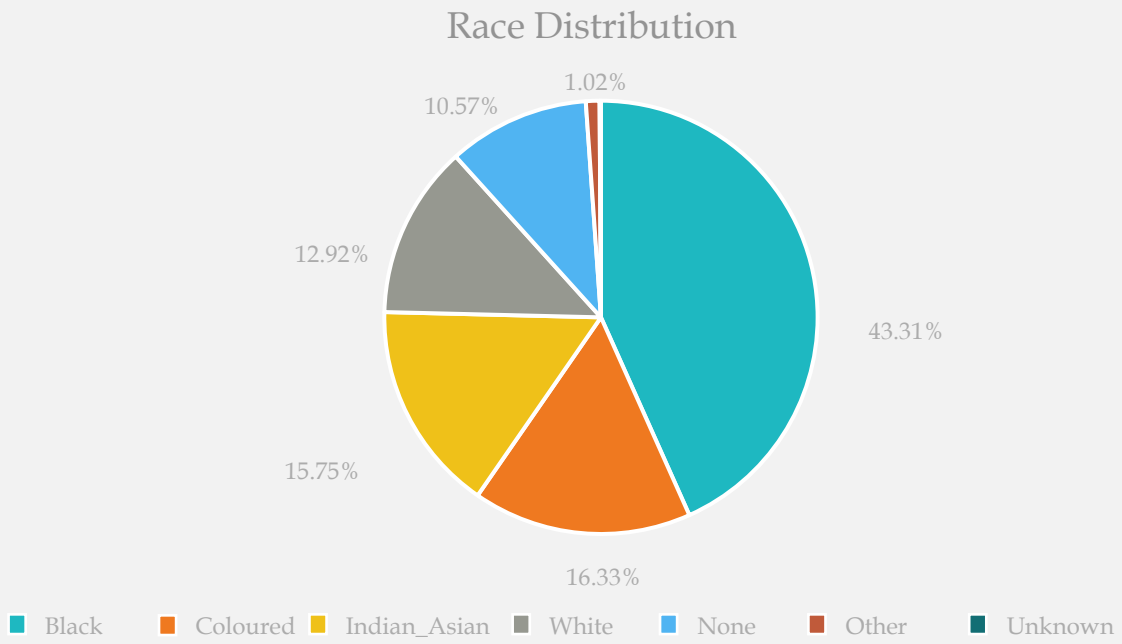


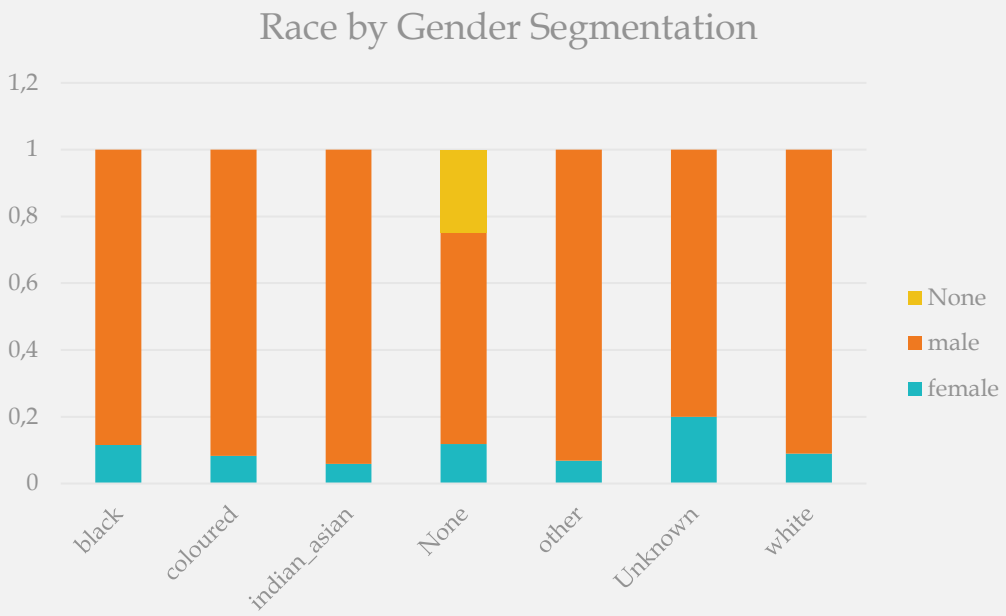
- Gauteng contributes ~37% of total viewership, followed by Western Cape (~19%), and KwaZulu-Natal (~10%)
- Free State has the **highest average watch time despite low volume (~3%)**
- Although North West accounts for ~4% of viewership, it shows a higher proportion of engaged viewers (~12%). Free State has slightly higher percentage of binge viewers (~7%)

Growth strategy should scale in **high-volume provinces** and learn from **high-engagement regions**

Note: we had 263 (<3%) unknown records

User base is predominantly black, with minimal variation in gender distribution across race groups





- The user base is heavily skewed towards **Black users (~43%)**, making this the dominant segment on the platform
- Other race groups (Coloured, Indian/Asian, White) each contribute **meaningfully but significantly less**, indicating a more concentrated audience base

- Across all race groups, **male users dominate viewership**, with females representing a smaller share
- **Gender distribution is consistent across race segments**, indicating that behaviour differences are unlikely to be driven by race-gender interactions

Growth opportunities are less about race-based targeting and more about **broad engagement strategies**, as behaviour is consistent across segments.

Note: we had 10 (0.1%) unknown records

Consumption is primarily driven by time of day and content, not demographics

TIME OF DAY

Evenings and nights drive highest engagement

Morning usage is low and shallow

CONTENT TYPE

Certain channels drive significantly higher engagement

Most-viewed ≠ most engaging

USER BEHAVIOUR

Majority of users are casual viewers

Engagement depth varies significantly

DEMOGRAPHICS

Age drives volume (young adults dominate)

Gender & Race has minimal impact

Province affects scale, not behaviour

Growth should focus on **when users watch and what they watch**, not who they are

SYNTHESISED INSIGHT | Subscription growth will be driven by increasing engagement, not just usage

01 Usage is already strong but concentrated in specific times and segments

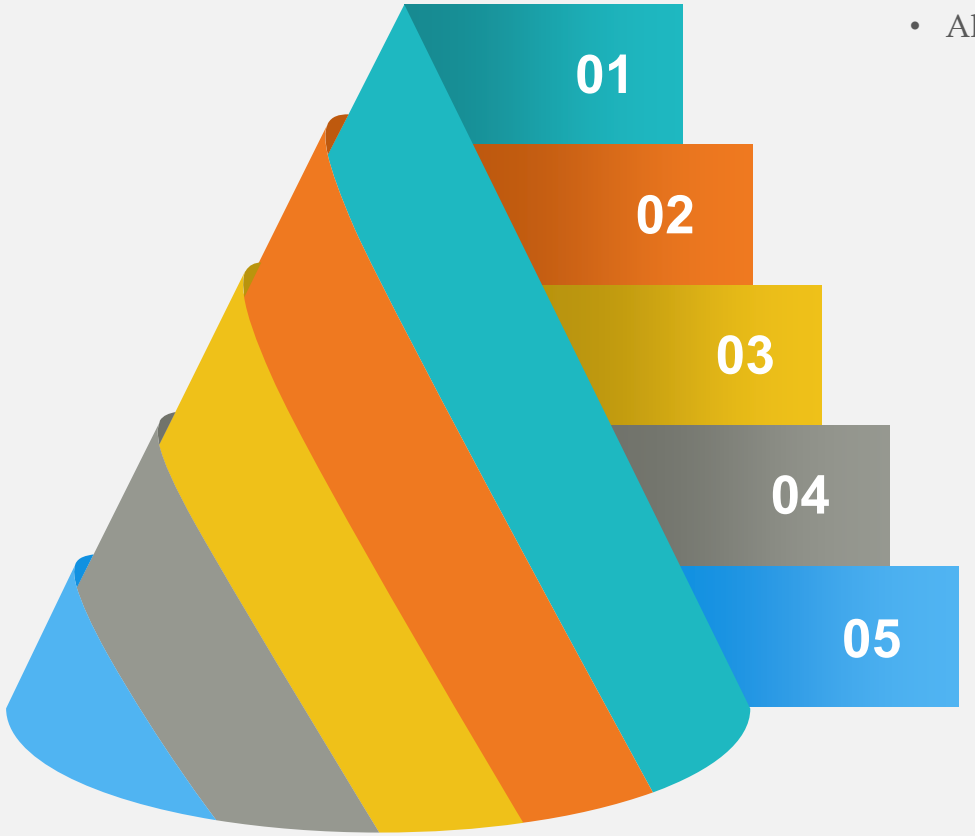
02 Engagement varies significantly by time of day and content type

03 A large base of casual users presents a conversion opportunity

04 High-engagement content is not optimally distributed

05 The biggest opportunity is not acquiring more users, but increasing the value extracted from existing users through deeper engagement..

RECOMMENDATIONS | Targeted content, personalisation, and timing optimisation will drive growth



Improve Content Strategy

- Promote high-engagement content during low-usage periods
- Align content releases with evening peak engagement

Increase Engagement Depth

- Introduce autoplay and curated playlists
- Highlight binge-worthy content

Personalise User Experience

- Recommend content based on past behaviour and preferences ("Because you watched…" features)
- Surface high-retention content during high engagement periods

Unlock Low Usage Periods

- Push high-engagement content during low-usage periods
- Use notifications to drive usage in off-peak periods

Focus Growth Strategy

- Scale in high-volume provinces (Gauteng, Western Cape)
- Apply learnings from high-engagement provinces

Thank you

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Annexure

Detailed breakdown of channel viewership by gender and age segmentation

Gender vs channel

Count of UserID Channels	Column Labels male	female
Africa Magic	7,70%	17,50%
Boomerang	6,91%	9,52%
Break in transmission	0,70%	0,20%
Cartoon Network	7,56%	11,46%
Channel O	10,48%	10,75%
CNN	5,24%	3,68%
DStv Events 1	0,98%	1,43%
E! Entertainment	3,39%	5,63%
ICC Cricket World Cup	15,33%	7,37%
kykNET	0,46%	0,10%
Live on SuperSport	0,01%	0,10%
MK	0,29%	0,51%
M-Net	1,18%	1,02%
SawSee	2,50%	2,46%
SuperSport Blitz	9,22%	6,04%
Supersport Live Event	17,59%	9,11%
Trace TV	9,31%	12,18%
Vuzu	1,13%	0,92%
Wimbledon	0,03%	0,00%
Grand Total	**100,00%**	**100,00%**

Age vs Channel

Average of duration_seconds Channels	Column Labels Child (<13)	Adult(36 - 59)	Young Adult (20 - 35)	Senior (60+)	Teenager (13 - 19)	Grand Total
Africa Magic	9,22%	40,13%	34,76%	16,51%	48,10%	37,05%
Boomerang	84,15%	65,99%	68,40%	21,60%	45,53%	66,64%
Break in transmission	0,00%	6,84%	11,17%	8,74%	3,42%	9,14%
Cartoon Network	10,09%	83,26%	48,19%	55,27%	59,51%	58,09%
Channel O	67,85%	117,56%	122,55%	88,14%	129,65%	119,44%
CNN	6,29%	109,00%	58,78%	35,59%	46,25%	88,26%
DStv Events 1	14,63%	28,23%	31,19%	0,00%	8,89%	29,82%
E! Entertainment	80,64%	77,35%	65,03%	50,10%	12,81%	67,27%
ICC Cricket World Cup 2011	162,80%	176,95%	184,28%	226,94%	193,63%	183,51%
kykNET	0,00%	33,44%	40,78%	110,48%	137,04%	41,45%
Live on SuperSport	0,00%	24,81%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	25,66%
MK	5,46%	12,49%	11,24%	0,00%	14,50%	11,71%
M-Net	26,40%	25,92%	18,54%	23,22%	32,74%	21,98%
SawSee	14,37%	27,60%	28,20%	17,73%	6,36%	27,39%
SuperSport Blitz	22,08%	70,41%	60,55%	127,68%	113,99%	66,88%
Supersport Live Events	54,66%	123,73%	127,97%	93,73%	73,10%	124,52%
Trace TV	732,63%	128,08%	130,64%	225,34%	185,75%	133,94%
Vuzu	0,00%	8,34%	8,81%	9,74%	10,28%	8,58%
Wimbledon	0,00%	1,82%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	1,88%
Grand Total	**100,00%**	**100,00%**	**100,00%**	**100,00%**	**100,00%**	**100,00%**

Confirms that content preferences vary by gender and age which supports personalisation strategy

Highlights when specific content performs best

Channels by Day of Week

Count of UserID	Column Labels							
Channels	Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Grand To
Supersport Live Events	11,91%	5,90%	8,90%	5,84%	22,08%	24,55%	20,82%	100,00%
ICC Cricket World Cup 2011	11,13%	4,71%	13,92%	33,72%	5,05%	13,99%	17,47%	100,00%
Channel O	13,24%	12,95%	12,48%	16,67%	14,57%	17,14%	12,95%	100,00%
Trace TV	16,70%	12,08%	15,34%	12,18%	15,76%	13,55%	14,39%	100,00%
SuperSport Blitz	12,72%	7,92%	16,52%	17,52%	14,96%	14,29%	16,07%	100,00%
Africa Magic	17,81%	10,83%	13,62%	13,39%	14,32%	15,95%	14,09%	100,00%
Cartoon Network	17,28%	11,85%	14,00%	10,47%	14,00%	15,26%	17,15%	100,00%
Boomerang	14,01%	11,76%	13,59%	14,29%	14,71%	15,69%	15,97%	100,00%
CNN	15,84%	14,46%	12,87%	12,48%	15,84%	16,63%	11,88%	100,00%
E! Entertainment	16,62%	11,99%	10,90%	11,99%	13,08%	17,44%	17,98%	100,00%
SawSee	13,73%	9,41%	16,86%	14,12%	12,94%	16,08%	16,86%	100,00%
M-Net	20,69%	12,07%	10,34%	12,07%	18,97%	17,24%	8,62%	100,00%
Vuzu	18,92%	6,31%	12,61%	11,71%	15,32%	18,92%	16,22%	100,00%
DStv Events 1	13,08%	14,02%	14,02%	17,76%	9,35%	14,02%	17,76%	100,00%
Break in transmission	9,09%	12,12%	37,88%	6,06%	7,58%	0,00%	27,27%	100,00%
kykNET	20,00%	15,56%	8,89%	24,44%	11,11%	13,33%	6,67%	100,00%
MK	18,75%	9,38%	6,25%	31,25%	12,50%	12,50%	9,38%	100,00%
Wimbledon	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	100,00%	100,00%
Live on SuperSport	0,00%	100,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	0,00%	100,00%
Grand Total	**14,19%**	**9,57%**	**13,22%**	**15,53%**	**14,41%**	**16,75%**	**16,33%**	**100,00%**

Channels by Time of Day

Count of UserID	Column Labels				
Channels	01. Early Morning	02. Morning	03. Afternoon	04. Evening	05. Night
Supersport Live Events	1,87%	22,74%	38,21%	15,88%	21,30%
ICC Cricket World Cup 2011	0,27%	26,76%	62,46%	8,26%	2,25%
Channel O	5,24%	26,48%	32,38%	13,05%	22,86%
Trace TV	6,20%	23,21%	34,14%	12,29%	24,16%
SuperSport Blitz	4,58%	27,34%	32,03%	13,17%	22,88%
Africa Magic	6,87%	21,54%	32,95%	13,62%	25,03%
Cartoon Network	5,67%	24,72%	32,16%	14,50%	22,95%
Boomerang	6,86%	26,05%	32,21%	12,32%	22,55%
CNN	7,72%	29,31%	27,33%	13,07%	22,57%
E! Entertainment	6,81%	20,16%	30,25%	13,35%	29,43%
SawSee	8,24%	22,75%	30,59%	8,63%	29,80%
M-Net	6,03%	20,69%	29,31%	12,93%	31,03%
Vuzu	12,61%	18,02%	29,73%	17,12%	22,52%
DStv Events 1	6,54%	24,30%	29,91%	15,89%	23,36%
Break in transmission	4,55%	13,64%	24,24%	1,52%	56,06%
kykNET	8,89%	13,33%	24,44%	15,56%	37,78%
MK	12,50%	21,88%	28,13%	6,25%	31,25%
Wimbledon	0,00%	33,33%	66,67%	0,00%	0,00%
Live on SuperSport	0,00%	50,00%	0,00%	0,00%	50,00%
Grand Total	**4,67%**	**24,55%**	**37,34%**	**12,75%**	**20,69%**

Identifies when specific content performs best which supports scheduling strategy